

DEEP DIVE — Croatian Co-Producer Shortlist

Researched 12 July 2026 (HAVC results PDFs 2024–2026 + Pravilnik + press). Goal: experienced co-producer on the 10 Sept HAVC prijavnica; Tomo keeps majority + final cut.

THE ADMINISTRATIVE KEY (from HAVC's Pravilnik)

- **Čl. 7 t. 2:** the application is scored partly on **the producer's previous 3 films** (festivals, admissions, sales). A support letter is worth ~nothing — the experienced company must sign the prijavnica **as co-producer** for their record to count.
- **Čl. 6:** applicant = independent producer in the Očevidnik, applying **jointly with the director**, with secured rights. Nothing forbids two Croatian co-producers on one project.
- **No majority-share rule found** between Croatian partners in the national category (majority/minority language exists only for international minority copros, čl. 34–38). **Verify with HAVC legal before 10 Sept: can the co-producer's filmography carry the scoring when the applicant d.o.o. is new?** (ocevidnici@havc.hr / HAVC pravna služba)
- **Čl. 8:** production-company fee capped at **7%** of the financial plan.
- Caveat: the public Pravilnik PDF predates the euro; the operative 2026 call text sits behind the portal — confirm clauses when the application account is open.

TOP 3 — approach in this order

1 • RESTART (Zagreb) — Vanja Jambrović / Tibor Keser / Oliver Sertić * THE CALL

- *Fiume o morte!* (Bezinović, 2025): **Rotterdam Tiger + FIPRESCI** (first Croatian film ever), **European Film Award — Documentary (Jan 2026)**, Croatia's Oscar submission, most-watched HR doc since independence.
- Financing architecture = literally ours: **HR/IT/SI copro, Eurimages €140k, Creative Europe, FVG fund, City of Rijeka** — and it's a **Rijeka film**. They know every desk we need.
- Doc-native house (Dokukino, doc school, distribution), director-first culture.
- Contact: restart@restarted.hr · Vanja Jambrović vanja@restarted.hr, +385 91 89 30 675 · oliver@restarted.hr
- Risk: post-EFA demand — pitch early, concrete, with the sizzle.

2 • WOLFGANG & DOLLY (Zagreb) — Tamara Babun Zovko

- Most consistently HAVC-funded doc shop 2024–26 (IDENTITET €70k · Lucić doc €61k · short €30k · plus €1.08M fiction). CineLink Rough Cut Boutique 2025.
- Eurimages paperwork experience as minority on *Body* (Seliškar). Babun: EURODOC, Ex Oriente, IDFA Academy.
- Best "finance/admin muscle per ego" ratio. Contact via wolfgangdolly.com (Vinkovićeva 15).

3 • HULAHOP (Zagreb) — Dana Budisavljević + Matea Milić

- HAVC doc grant Jun 2026 (€65k); *Diary of Diana B.* 35k HR admissions; house built to serve director-driven personal films.
- Italy line: co-produced with **Stefilm (Torino)** for ZDF/ARTE, RAI, HRT. Six-person office = real admin.
- Contact: ured@hulahop.hr.

BACKUPS

- **Fade In** — producing a sea doc right now (*Na morskome plavom žalu*, €80k Jun 2026); Beldocs 2026 winner; udruuga/collective structure. office@fadein.hr
- **Factum (Puhovski)** — 80+ docs, ZagrebDox founder, DOK Leipzig Golden Dove 2025; maximum credibility, institution temperament, mostly domestic financing.
- **Petnaesta umjetnost (Osvadić)** — the purest producer-serves-auteur model (13 films with Dević, incl. water docs); small, no Eurimages. Good second co-producer.
- **Pipser (Čogelja)** — Producers on the Move 2023, superb EU network; no recent HAVC doc production grant.
- **Rijeka add-on: Filmaktiv** — only verified Rijeka doc producer (€79k Jun 2026); community/education profile, zero Eurimages › local partner alongside a Zagreb lead, not lead.
- **Split wildcard: Marinis Media** — *Nun of Your Business*; €65k Dec 2025; co-develops with **Alessio Bozzer, Trieste** (Italy line). Director-producer with her own slate.
- **Kinoteka** — *Dražen* (2024): sports-legend box-office hit, SI/RS/US copro — relevant to the Vegas/ISHOF angle, but fiction-first.

AVOID (for this project)

- **Nukleus** — internationally heavyweight, but highest power-balance risk for a first-timer keeping majority + final cut.
- **Antitalent** — red-hot, zero bandwidth (Pek also runs Pula FF); doc output thin.
- **Gral, Terminal 3** — no doc track record found. **"Val" (Rijeka)** / **"Motion" (Split)** — could not verify these exist as doc producers; dead ends.

DEAL FRAME (proposal to bring to the first coffee)

Tomo's d.o.o. = majority rights-holder + delegates director's contract; partner = co-producer on the HAVC prijavnica (their filmography scores), fee within the 7% cap, defined scope: HAVC/Eurimages administration, HRT + foreign copro negotiation, festival/finance strategy. Creative control + final cut stay with the director (2023 chapter approval sits with the four per the working paper — non-negotiable). Sequence: Restart coffee ASAP with sizzle › if slate-full, W&D + Hulahop in the same week › co-production agreement signed before the 10 Sept rok; name on IDFA Forum entry as "in negotiation" if timing allows.